

you go higher up, you have really good tech, but it also comes at top dollar, the high-end ultra-short throws of the world priced over Rs 75K."

So that sweet spot in the middle is empty, and Lumio puts a dent in that.

India buys 14 million TVs a year. It buys just 120,000 home projectors. In the US or China, the projector-to-TV ratio is 15%. In India, it's less than 1%. "That's not a gap. That's a huge opportunity," Raghu adds. "We thought that if we solve a lot of the pain points and bring in that at the right price point, [it] will basically help in catalyzing this particular category."

Kailash is direct: "We think that this can actually become 10X over the next four to five years."

Designed and built for India

When Lumio began this journey alongside their TVs, there were no projector manufacturing setups in the country. "We started this project pretty much at the same time as TV," Raghu says. "But then we realized that... there are no factories that are manufacturing projectors in India." That delayed the launch, but gave them time to reimagine what a projector for Indian conditions would look like.

"India is going to be a dusty country, whether we like it or not," he notes. "And we realized that if you don't have what is a completely sealed optical light engine, this product will struggle."

The Arc 5 and Arc 7, launched under Lumio's Arc Light engine architecture, reflect that thinking.

Raghu lists the top reasons Indians hesitate to buy projectors. "One, they think it requires a big space... Two, people think that setting up that entire



thing is complex... Three, people felt that it is expensive."

Kailash adds: "Even if it's plug and play, you keep it on a certain place, it doesn't give you the correct elevation."

The Under-Stand, essentially a built-in kickstand, solves a common elevation problem without requiring any ceiling mounts or external props.

The design itself avoids the clunky, industrial look of AV gear. "We didn't want serrated plastic boxes. These are meant to be touched, carried, kept on a nightstand or coffee table."

Raghu says these changes came not just from in-house design, but from meeting with potential users. "We've done a fairly... big survey. We've got about 5000 plus responses... We double-clicked on that entire thing."

The result is a clean, minimalist design. Rounded edges. Built-in Netflix. Seamless Google TV. And most critically, STR8 auto-keystone correction. "This thing works," Raghu says, recounting a customer who came to one of their meetups and stress-tested the Arc 7. "That guy actually put the entire device through its paces."

Arc 5 and Arc 7: A tale of two screens

Both projectors are certified Google TV devices. Both support Netflix out of the box. Both aim to deliver cinema-sized screens in under five minutes of setup. But their personalities differ.

The Arc 5 is light and portable at 1.3 kg with 200 ANSI lumens, designed for bedrooms, or travel. It's a Netflix-and-chill machine that fits in a backpack. The Arc 7 doubles the brightness,

packs larger 8W stereo speakers, and is for living rooms and shared spaces.

Both feature STR8 (Smooth Trapezoidal Recalibration), which auto-adjusts keystone angles and focus in real time with TOF sensors.

The invisible moat

Behind all of this is Lumio's digital layer, TLDR: a dashboard for sports scores, music discovery, and device management that quietly lives inside the projector and TV UI.

"To us, that's the real big area of focus and investment," Raghu says. "You can't bring in new products every two, three months but nifty little features that will add value to customers' lives. Those are things that we're looking to build on the TLDR side."

"We've built a use case around music and sports," he says. "We want to do [movies], man. Trust me, we have spent six months building out something for movies."

Part of Lumio's confidence stems from the playbook they used to build community trust around their TVs, and are now replicating for projection.

"We're also doing a bunch of these community meetups," Raghu says, befittingly calling them Luminati: a mix of customer meetups and live demos.

"The best ideas don't necessarily come from a meeting room," Sudeep Sahu, Head of Product, interjects. "It comes from people who are actually passionate about the space." **d**

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